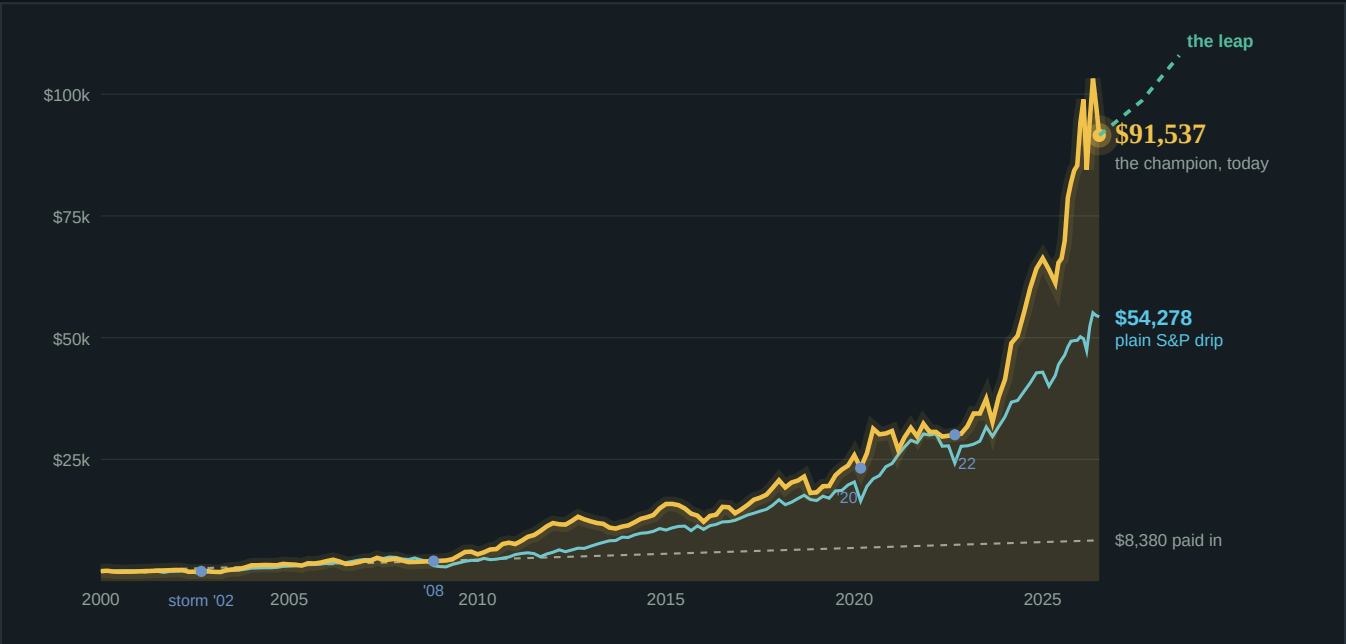


The July Leap

The Sigma Trader's monthly postcard: where the arc has been, where it glows tonight, and where your next \$20 goes. Data through Friday, July 17. Published July 18, 2026.



The whole flight, one picture: \$2,000 launched in January 2000 + \$20 a month (\$8,380 paid in, the dashed line). The gold comet is the champion at \$91,537 today - eleven times the fuel spent - sailing through four storms on the way. The cyan line is the same drip into plain S&P, \$54,278. Measured in the walk-forward simulation, borrowing costs charged, no peeking.

DRIP on schedule	MIX eight assets	BRAKE cruising 2.0×	SKIES VIX 18.8 calm	GATES 3 of 3 green	REAL \$ practice mode
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The word for July is **poise**. Markets took a breather - the spring's hottest stocks cooled off, headlines got loud, oil jumped - and the system's answer was the calmest sentence it knows: *all gates green, keep cruising, keep dripping*. The arc bent -6.4% this month. It has bent this way 24 times in 26 years, and after every single one it went on to a brand-new high. That is what the dashed green line off the comet's nose is drawn from: not hope - **habit**.

Where the next twenty goes

The plan's answer never needs a hot take: the next \$20 buys **the whole mix, automatically** - a little more of whatever has drifted below its target weight, so you quietly buy what's on sale. Here is this month's pour:



one twenty, eight ingredients - poured automatically, every month

Ingredient	What it is	Of your \$20
The S&P 500	the big American 500	\$6.75
Steady bonds	the long-term ballast	\$4.15
The tech 100	the Nasdaq's engine room	\$3.00
Gold	the ancient anchor	\$2.80
Small companies	tomorrow's mid-caps	\$1.10
Rest of the world	beyond the US	\$0.90
Momentum, mid-size	what's already winning	\$0.75
Momentum, large	the big winners' lane	\$0.55

Lifetime-average champion recipe; the momentum slices grow as their track record does. Fractional shares mean all eight fit inside one twenty.

Lean on these

THE DRIP ITSELF - Twenty in, every month, rain or shine. Across everything the lab has ever tested, the contribution is the strongest lever in the whole machine - stronger than any clever tweak. Level it up when life allows and you out-lever every strategy change.

BORING BALLAST - Bonds and gold are a third of the pour, and July is why: they let the arc climb without white knuckles. Gold is up about 20% on the year - the anchor is pulling.

THE ROBOT'S WATCH - A brake checks the skies every minute the market is open, ready to glide the book toward interest-earning cash if a storm builds. Tonight it reads calm. You were never on watch duty - that's the point.

Glide past these

CHASING JULY'S FIREWORKS - The spring's hottest chip stocks just took the summer's sharpest turn. The mix already owns the winners' lane through its momentum slices - you get the ride without picking the horse.

DIY BORROWING - Leverage is the robot's craft, practiced on a paper book behind a gate. On a personal account, plain and unborrowed is the strong move. Let the machine do the tightrope.

WATCHING DAILY - A drip plan pays you for patience: every dip your \$20 lands in is a discount. The scoreboard that matters prints monthly - this page - not at 3am.

Four headlines, four calm answers

Oil leapt 10% as the Middle East flared

Tensions between the US and Iran boiled over and crude jumped above \$82 - a one-month high (CNBC, July 16). Gas may pinch; markets, remarkably, kept their cool: the fear gauge sits at a mellow 18.8.

The plan's answer: nothing to do - and that's a feature. If storms build, the brake glides toward cash that currently pays real interest, all by itself, minutes-fast. Shelter with a yield.

The market rotated out of spring's favorites

Chipmakers cooled and the spotlight moved on - the S&P eased 1.6% for the week while, quietly, 87% of early earnings reports beat expectations (CNBC; Seeking Alpha, July 17). Strong engine, new seating chart.

The plan's answer: this is exactly why you own eight ingredients instead of one hero. Rotations shuffle the leaderboard; the mix keeps a seat at every table, and July's drip buys the newly-discounted seats.

The Fed holds steady - and cash still pays

The July 28-29 meeting is expected to keep rates right where they are, with inflation watched closely (Federal Reserve minutes; CNBC, July 8). The 10-year sits near 4.55%.

The plan's answer: higher-for-now rates are the quiet gift of this era - the brake's cash refuge earns Treasury-bill interest, so playing defense is never dead money. Patience, paid.

Gold's golden year rolls on

Even after catching its breath this month, gold shines near \$4,017 an ounce - up about 20% from a year ago (Trading Economics, July 17).

The plan's answer: the \$2.80 gold slice in every twenty is the ancient anchor doing modern work - it zigs when stocks zag, most of the time, and asks nothing of you in return.

THE 24-FOR-24 BADGE. A month like July (-6.4%) has happened 24 times before on this arc since 2000 - the dot-com winter, 2008, the 2020 flash-storm, the 2022 bear. The record after those 24: **24 new all-time highs.** The 25th is now on the clock, and the May peak (\$103,189) is the line it's chasing. History measured, future unwritten - but that is one well-rehearsed bounce.

The arc, the node, the leap

The arc - the last three statement lines

	May	June	July 17	Since 2000
The champion	\$103,189	\$97,743	\$91,537	11.0× the money in
Plain S&P drip	\$55,108	\$54,561	\$54,278	6.5× the money in
Money paid in	\$8,340	\$8,360	\$8,380	the only guaranteed row

The leap - if the next years rhyme with the last 26

From today's \$91,537 + \$20/month	by 2031	by 2036
At the champion's measured pace (12.6%/yr)	about \$167,000	about \$304,000
At the plain-index pace (10.0%/yr)	about \$148,000	about \$241,000
New money you'd add	\$1,200	\$2,400

Paces are what each line actually measured, 2000-2026. The future keeps its own counsel - which is why the drip, the mix, and the brake do the promising here, not the projection.

The plot, on one card

Directive	A monthly report for unisona.ai users: how the next \$20 leaps, with current events in mind.
Promoted system	The champion mix + streaming brake, now also running a live \$25,000 practice book (reading \$24,998, cruising 2.0×, started July 17).
Evidence	Walk-forward simulation 2000-2026 (run July 17; monthly path on file) · live brake state saved July 18, 17:38 UTC · market feed July 18 · news of July 16-18 (CNBC, Seeking Alpha, Trading Economics, federalreserve.gov).
Boundaries	Practice mode: simulation + paper only. Real dollars wait behind the plan's own evidence gate, and every real-money click belongs to a human - with a licensed advisor for the personal stuff.
Next action	Keep the drip. Skim next month's Leap. If you do one extra thing in July: nudge the twenty toward twenty-five.

See you at the August Leap - same arc, fresh node. · Full method & every receipt: docs/investing-2k-plan.html and experiments/ in the unisona.ai repo.